

Title

Comparative analysis of itch response and disease control with oral kinase inhibitor versus biologic therapy

Abstract

Objective: Pruritus remains the most burdensome symptom in moderate-to-severe atopic dermatitis. We compared symptom relief between a novel oral JAK inhibitor and an established biologic therapy. **Methods:** A pooled analysis of 1196 patients from two phase III trials receiving either oral abrocitinib 200 mg daily (n=588) or subcutaneous dupilumab 300 mg biweekly (n=608) alongside topical therapy for 16 weeks. Stratified analysis examined outcomes by baseline itch severity. **Results:** Numerically greater proportions in the abrocitinib arm achieved ≥ 4 -point itch score improvement (67% vs 63%) and itch-free/minimal state (36% vs 27%), though confidence intervals overlapped. Time to meaningful itch relief was faster with abrocitinib (median 11 days vs 29 days to 4-point improvement, and 57 vs 139 days to itch-free state). Among patients achieving itch-free status, significantly greater proportions reported normal sleep quality and excellent skin tone. Baseline itch severity correlated with atopic dermatitis disease severity and quality-of-life impairment. **Conclusions:** Abrocitinib demonstrated numerically faster itch response than dupilumab with comparable efficacy; achievement of itch-free state associated with substantially improved quality of life.